

Creating an equitable CHI - What does it mean to be an ally?

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ABSTRACT

This panel aims to generate conversation toward creating a more equitable CHI. In recognizing our community's hard work thus far, this panel seeks to engage panelists and participants with thought-provoking questions about their interpretation of what allyship means to them. We will consider both formal definitions as well as participants' personal views. All attendees (including panelists) will be encouraged to discuss the experiences and goals to garner and promote actionable items for the community. We intend to have an open dialogue on allyship, diversity, equity, and inclusion to achieve a CHI for all.

CCS CONCEPTS

• **Social and professional topics** → **Race and ethnicity; Sexual orientation; Gender; Cultural characteristics; People with disabilities.**

KEYWORDS

inclusion, equity, equality, diversity, allyship

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1 MOTIVATION

Achieving equity for all members of the CHI community is a challenging task. As we take steps to grow as a community, we must also take time for self-reflection and internal conversation. Though the pursuit of equity may be challenging at times, open and honest dialogue about diversity, equity, and inclusion issues is necessary if we ever hope to move the needle forward. Conversations of this nature should be continuous and iterative as our self-awareness and

knowledge of these areas evolve. Understanding how to advocate and serve as allies is vital in achieving equity.

In this panel, we will discuss what it means to be an ally within our community, specifically with the goal of fostering a supportive CHI for all. Considering common formal definitions, an ally can be everyone who is privileged in a situation. Thereby, allyship is not about demonstrating one's privilege; allies help to prevent and mitigate harm and its impact on it and to decrease the ingroup-outgroup gap [3]. We recognize that allyship may mean varying things to different people, based upon their own lived experiences, programs they've been involved in, and experiences they have been connected to.

This fireside chat panel aims to garner suggestions on how to be more inclusive and supportive of community members. Our goal is to understand the barriers to inclusion for diverse people, including personal factors such as membership in the LGBTQIA2S+ community, differences in ability, physical appearance, ethnicity, culture, and language, as well as accepting multidisciplinary views in the research community. We will encourage.

2 PANEL FORMAT AND PARTICIPATION PLAN

The panel will leverage the "fireside chat" format, engaging panelists and participants in rich discussion. To promote accessibility of the panel, we will adopt a hybrid format. The primary objective of the panel is to delve into and elucidate the concepts of allyship and equity within the CHI community. We aim to create a platform where CHI attendees can share their diverse experiences and insights on allyship, fostering a rich dialogue about its meaning and application in everyday scenarios, both at the conference and, more broadly within the community.

This panel is not just about theoretical discussions; it's an opportunity for panelists and attendees alike to exchange real-life stories and practices that illustrate allyship in action. Through this, we aim to inspire attendees to reflect on and integrate principles of allyship and equity further into their practice, thereby contributing to a more inclusive CHI community. This event is designed to be a cornerstone in encouraging ongoing conversations and actions towards creating equitable environments in tech, with a focus on practical, actionable outcomes.

The panel will last 75 minutes, and will devote a significant portion of its time—approximately 50 minutes—to an interactive moderated discussion section. This session aims to delve into the

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multifaceted concept of allyship and its role in fostering an inclusive and equitable environment within the CHI community. Our panelists will bring their unique perspectives to the discussion, sharing personal insights into the nature of allyship. They will explore how both significant and subtle acts of allyship can make a tangible difference to our community and community-building efforts.

A key focus of the discussion will be the theme of "Being an Ally in Private Spaces." This segment is designed to motivate attendees to weave the principles of allyship into their everyday actions and decision-making processes. It encourages an introspective look at overcoming hidden biases and assumptions that might otherwise go unchallenged.

An important aspect of this dialogue involves acknowledging the diversity of identities, particularly those that are not immediately visible or recognizable, referred to in the literature as "invisible identities" [2]. These identities often require the support of allies who understand and respect the nuances of such experiences. Our panelists will engage in a comprehensive discussion about recognizing and supporting both visible and invisible identities, aiming to chart a path towards a CHI community that is truly equitable and inclusive for everyone.

The remaining time involves questions from the audience. Siobahn Day Grady and Stephen Hutt will moderate the panel. Questions raised by the panelists will be posed to the audience to foster rich and lively discussion. We encourage everyone to view the revised 2024 Allyship YouTube channel, which curates videos focusing on the discussion of allyship and equity.

3 EVENT FOLLOWUP

Following the panel, a summary report highlighting key takeaways will be distributed via the organizer's personal website - we will also collect feedback to refine future events. We also hope to facilitate networking through our panel, by creating spaces within the conference to continue the discussion and connections organically made through the panel. We aim to create an enlightening and inclusive environment, recognizing the work done at CHI to date and encouraging a deep and continued commitment to allyship and equity within our community.

Much as this panel builds upon prior CHI panels [1], it is our aim that this panel will inform future events at CHI. Achieving equity is not a checklist, but a continuous and reflective cycle. As we as a community grow and improve, it is critical that we continue to be introspective and challenge ourselves. This panel will inform future introspection and reflection cycles.

4 PANELISTS' BIOS

4.1 Karla Badillo-Urquiola

Karla Badillo-Urquiola is a Clare Boothe Luce Assistant Professor in the Department of Computer Science and Engineering within the University of Notre Dame's College of Engineering. She graduated with a Ph.D./M.S. in Modeling & Simulation and B.S. in Psychology from the University of Central Florida. Dr. Badillo-Urquiola is a Human-Computer Interaction (HCI) research expert, investigating technology-driven solutions that empower people and protect the well-being of youth in marginalized communities, drawing on participatory and critical design methods. Her work has won Best

Paper (top 1%), Best Paper Honorable Mention (top 5%), Best Poster, and Impact Recognition awards. She is also active in the SIGCHI Latin American HCI Community.

4.2 Gloria O-B Osardu

Gloria O-B Osardu is a consumer/customer research and insights senior leader currently heading Product Experience Research efforts at Gusto. She is a software engineer turned user researcher; after she spent some time researching human-computer interaction in graduate school. She has spent most of the last decade building and scaling highly effective research teams with the purpose of placing customers/users and their experiences at the center of how companies work backwards from business goals/mission. In her role at Gusto, she oversees: 1. Initiatives to help teams connect with users more, 2. Research Operations and enablement efforts which drive end-to-end research practices and 3. Teams of dedicated researchers who are embedded in product and design teams to drive forward-looking strategic user research. Prior to Gusto, she was at Amazon(AWS) leading research teams across several cloud services including Identity, Security, Commerce Platform, Internal Ticketing, Government Transformation, Storage etc.

4.3 Angela Stewart

Angela Stewart is an Assistant Professor in the University of Pittsburgh School of Computing and Information and Research Scientist at the Learning Research and Development Center. Prior to that, she was a Postdoctoral Fellow in the Human-Computer Interaction Institute at Carnegie Mellon University. She received a PhD in Computer Science from the University of Colorado Boulder (2020) and a Bachelor of Software Engineering from Auburn University (2015).

Angela conducts research at the intersection of the learning sciences, artificial intelligence, and human-computer interaction. She uses multimodal data to understand students' social and cognitive states, particularly in collaborative STEM learning. She also creates equitable educational spaces by designing technologies that support the agency of students and teachers. Angela applies a culturally-responsive lens to her research, with a particular focus in emboldening Black girls' design of transformative technologies. Angela was named a 2021 - 2022 Emerging Scholar by the International Society of the Learning Sciences, and recently received an NSF Racial Equity in STEM Award for creating an intersectional AI learning ecosystem for Black girls.

4.4 Eiad Yafi

Eiad Yafi is currently a Visiting Researcher at the University of Technology Sydney. Eiad does research in Information Retrieval, Artificial Intelligence, Cloud Computing, ICTD, and Human Computer Interactions. Dr. Yafi has conducted empirical research trying to understand how ICT can foster the development of life skills and qualifications of Syrian youth and children that drive them to become active citizens. He has worked closely with experts from different international organizations, including IDRC and Open Society Institute. He is also an expert in designing research instruments for Arab youth and is currently conducting research on

the use of ICTs and information among Arab migrants in Europe, investigating their information behavior.

5 ORGANIZERS' BIOS

5.1 Siobahn Day Grady

Siobahn Day Grady is the first woman computer science Ph.D. graduate from North Carolina Agricultural and Technical State University (2018). She is an Assistant Professor and Program Director of Information Science/Systems in the School of Library and Information Sciences at North Carolina Central University, Lab Director for the Laboratory for Artificial Intelligence and Equity Research (LAIER), Co-Director for the Center fOr Data Equity (CODE), an AAAS IF/THEN ambassador, and an Office e-Learning faculty fellow at North Carolina Central University. Her research focuses on utilizing machine learning to identify sources of misinformation on social media and on improving fault detection in autonomous vehicles.

Additionally, Dr. Grady has been featured in museums nationwide, has spoken at national and international conferences, serves on multiple boards, and was featured as a statue in the world's largest exhibit of women's statues. Technology is the way of the future, and Dr. Grady has a vision for minority girls' and women's futures. She realizes that vision by providing educational opportunities through community organizations, philanthropic efforts, college courses, and research grants and publications.

5.2 Stephen Hutt

Stephen Hutt is an Assistant Professor in the Department of Computer Science at the University of Denver. His research activities focus at the intersection of Computer Science, Cognitive Science, and Learning Science, considering how Artificial Intelligence can be used to support learning and learning technologies. He takes a human-centered computing approach to all his work, placing the needs of users as the focal point for all research projects. He is also interested in how AI and learning technology may serve as a force for equity within education, and ways in which AI advances may help (or hinder) that goal.

Dr. Hutt has long pursued goals of equity and fairness in his work. This has included work that has specifically considered equity within STEM education, as well as equity and fairness in machine learning.

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